Developing answers to public questions

DISCUSSION WORKSHEET

Group _____ Question no. _____

Assigned question _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Write for **non-experts**, in clear language. Draw on your own expertise and on what you know of other experts' views, including those outside your specialty.

Consensus is not required. Where experts disagree, explain why. A useful answer can show why a definitive answer is not yet possible.

1 Preliminary Answer

What would you tell a member of the public? Draft a direct answer in 3-5 sentences.

2 Evidence and Reasoning

What evidence and expert knowledge support the answer, and why? Distinguish established findings from assumptions and projections.

Developing answers to public questions

DISCUSSION WORKSHEET / CONTINUED

Group _____ Question no. _____

3 Confidence and Qualifications

How confident are you, and why? Does the answer depend on the technology, assumptions, time frame, or future developments?

4 Uncertainties and Disagreements

What is unknown or contested? Record differing views among experts, including your own, the reasons for them, and the evidence or assumptions involved.

5 Areas for Further Work

What additional evidence, expertise, or discussion would improve the answer or help resolve key uncertainties and disagreements?